

EVOLUTIONARY PHASES IN REGARD TO THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE REALMS OF FEELINGS, REASON, AND WILL

Greetings and blessings, my dearest, dearest friends. Welcome to all of you at the beginning of this new working season. Our path together will again proceed in a very significant way. Many of my friends have made outstanding progress, some of you perhaps much more than you realize. Often what you designate as progress is not necessarily realistic, and what really is progress may seem, at first, as the very opposite. Only retrospectively are you able to see how much the very aspects that may discourage you at first are the initial steps in your personal evolution. Progress must bring you face to face with your pitfalls, with those things you have so busily ignored. So, coming into your own sometimes appears, to the uninitiated and still self-involved, as an unwelcome development one cannot identify as growth. In reality, this may be the most meaningful step, the very key to your freedom, to finding your true identity.

This group, this entire venture, this entire spiritual endeavor, is a pulsating, living reality, my friends. It has a spiritual form. I discussed this occasionally, especially at certain thresholds. It is indeed a growing, living organism, expanding in a more beautiful way than ever. This moving organism is very aware of itself, as every living thing becomes as it develops. This applies to an individual entity as well as to collective entities such as nations, groups, common endeavors. The same psychic laws apply. Consciousness must exist to some degree in all living organisms. Group consciousness can be extremely dim, as for example in animals or plants; it can be very highly developed, provided the individuals who are forming the group are predominantly in a state of raised consciousness. The degree of consciousness of a group organism reflects the sum total of its individuals, just as the overall consciousness of an individual reflects the sum total of the various layers he is constituted of. Those layers of consciousness are the cause of inner dissension, conflict, and pain. When unification occurs, the layers melt into one, being activated and moved by the divine kernel.

When the overall organism tends toward growth, purification, and union in a realistic way, those layers (or aspects) which resist gradually die off. Resisting the growth process does not necessarily manifest in theory as a concept or principle, but may nevertheless appear in practice since what is really necessary may not be compatible with the hopeful illusion. Thus when aspects of the organism stem against the necessary steps of growth, the self-selective process of dying off, or exclusion, sets in so as to protect the whole organism from not being affected by the life defeating attitudes. This exclusion protects the whole organism and its continuous growth. The process of physical death is a result of the same principle. Physical matter dies off only because underlying attitudes are devoted to life defeating attitudes, fear of truth and love with all their derivatives. These fears induce decay, finally manifesting "outwardly."

Hence, what first appears as destruction is, at closer view and with deeper insight, nothing but destruction of destructiveness. Even though it may be painful to endure at the moment, it is often the most life preserving event, born out of the overall health of the organism. For the unhealthy organism could tolerate the life defeating attitudes much longer. Death is overcome when the whole of the organism no longer resists life, truth, love so that no deadening stuff has to secrete itself from the whole of the organism. This principle is very important to comprehend in all questions of life, individual and collective.

Tonight's lecture is once again, as so often at the beginning of a new work season, simultaneously a recapitulation in terms of the present emphasis, and a forecasting, a blueprint. It foreshadows the structure or form that will be filled out by the individuals in the year to come. When you retrospectively observe the sequence of the lectures and of the individual pathwork (those who really follow deeply by overcoming their fear of self), you will see that both follow more or less in broad lines this blueprint.

I mentioned before the various layers of consciousness. This is what I should like to discuss in particular aspects. It will then open up a new understanding about why it is so exceedingly difficult to let go of the overcontrol of the ego. If self-realization is to be attained, a new balance structure must be attained in which the ego assumes an entirely different role. And all of my friends should, once again, consider seriously what this path is. Why are they involved in it? What is its function? Too often the vagueness or confusion about this brings unnecessary difficulties and misunderstandings. The function of this path is not to remove one symptom or another that becomes bothersome in a person's life. This is not a treatment of sickness. Nor is the path simply a way of becoming a better person, of developing spiritually. All of this happens, of course. But it must be fully understood by all of you, no matter how far you decide to follow, that the aim is the total realization of the divine kernel. And this is not merely a theory. It is indeed possible, right here and right now.

Let us first of all recapitulate the meaning of self-realization. I shall attempt to use new words in order to reach you in a more dynamic way. It means to bring forth as a living reality the kernel of your spiritual being -- that kernel of self that is eternal. This is, I repeat, not a religious concept, applicable for a faraway future. It is immediately available. How can some of the results or manifestations be best described? I might say that a new "area" is awakened, located in the center of your body in the solar plexus region. Out of this area, new life flows. New feelings, a new sense of perceiving, of reacting, of feeling, of experiencing, of responding, of knowing, of seeing things, life, people, values, sequences of events. Everything is endowed with a new luminosity and a deeper meaningfulness. Beliefs either change, or if they remain the same in words, they feel differently or are the same for different reasons. The scope of an opinion, a conviction, or of sensation widens and deepens. Everything becomes fuller. The self becomes at one and the same time intensely personal and individualistic as well as universal. What appeared to have been incompatible contradictions suddenly unify without a breach of logic. Fear vanishes, and life becomes unending pleasure just because its opposite is no longer feared. The opposite of the desired state of fulfillment and happiness is not avoided, but its illusory nature is unmasked as a result of having gone through it. Thus there is nothing to fear. The creative power of the self is available at all times, again as a result of having freed the personality of fear.

These words are inadequate to describe the state called self-realization. But it may give some of you a glimmer of what is to come because perhaps you have begun to experience it to a small degree once in a while. It comes gradually and yet, at times, suddenly. Again this contradiction is no contradiction at all. This state is possible only when all surface layers, all contradictory trends of consciousness have unified with the innermost being.

In order to extend your understanding, it will be helpful to view man's spiritual history, his evolution, from a certain vantage point. At one phase in the history of his spiritual existence, the entity was Godlike. He was totally moved by the creative, cosmic forces. He expressed the universal consciousness in every breath and every move of his eternally living existence. At a certain point, through a certain turn of direction of his consciousness, he removed himself from this kernel. By striving away from the innermost kernel, he has become involved in erroneous ideas, and consequently in destructive reactions and feelings, and further consequently in blindness, unhappiness, suffering. Along with this process, each removal from the kernel created itself as a new layer of consciousness. Each further layer covered the last one, thus thickening the wall around the kernel. When these new layers of consciousness formed themselves, the thus separated consciousness functioned by itself, nourished by the error that brought about the overlayers in the first place, rather than being nourished by the source. This is why man experiences so often this "going around in circles," the turning around endlessly, on and on. The freshness of approach issuing from the source is indivisible, unifies all splits and conflicts. This, in very broad lines, constitutes man's spiritual history and what brought him into the state he now finds himself in.

Again going back a bit, there came a juncture when all this pain, with no visible way out, induced violence, rage, greed, separateness, and many other destructive emotions. This still exists today in man's soul. Suffering, blindness, hopelessness produce loveless feelings, selfishness, and often the most violent and evil reactions toward the world. At the dawn of mankind, when man was little more aware of himself than an animal, he was completely expressing and acting out these destructive feelings. Primitive man knows no inhibition and no conscience. He is too unconnected from his fellow creatures to sense their pain as identical to his own. His suffering has made him too blind because his blindness has led him into suffering. Thus he destroys and indulges in his destructive impulses.

At later stages in his evolution he learns that this brings him into conflict with his environment. Gradually, consciousness expands as a result of living experience. The first reasoning processes show the individual that letting out what he feels, unchecked, produces eventually more pain. Thus a "social conscience" develops, which is also the result of his instinct of self-preservation. But it is merely expedience that dictates this kind of conscience. It is still far removed from the inner experience of oneness with his fellow man. But he comes to the threshold where he learns to keep his urge to destroy in abeyance. Through many life experiences, through millennia of living under varied circumstances, each entity learns to develop his faculties of reason (seeing cause and effect of his actions) and of will (self-discipline not to give in to these primitive impulses). You will appreciate the importance of this step in the entity's evolution.

The realm of feelings is at this point predominantly a seething mass of pain denied and therefore of violence, hate, and malice. Yet the realm of feelings is the most alive and creative faculty. It is that which is self-perpetuating. As long as the feeling world is predominantly negative and destructive, its self-perpetuating nature creates impulses and compulsions of a highly damaging

nature. This is why it is so much feared. It is held in check only by the power to reason, to use the mind, and by the will power to hold back, to discipline all spontaneous impulses.

When this consciousness grows and the negativity of the feeling world becomes obvious, man does his best to deny, to cover up, to hinder, to inactivate the realm of feelings. However, what happens then is that in this process the spiritual self becomes also further removed. For it resides directly within the realm of feelings. The creative mass of feelings is the divine even if it now manifests in such a destructive way. So, when reason and will erect a barricade around the realm of feelings so as to be safe from its negative self-perpetuating creativeness, they also erect a further barricade around the divine kernel -- the positive self-perpetuating process. It is nevertheless necessary for each entity to go through this phase before the direction can be reversed.

This is why you fear the realm of feelings. You are indoctrinated with the safety measure you have learned for so long, and now you must unlearn it. You fear the realm of feelings because it is still, in part, in its primitive state. You are still imbued with the self-command you have learned throughout many existences, "I must keep this destructiveness under control." The more the feelings are denied, the less can the destructive feelings transform themselves into their original state. Thus a consciousness builds itself that is based on reason. For a long time in the history of evolution, reason and will seem the savior, the saving grace, that which controls, prevents, and dominates the realm of feelings.

An untold number of entities find themselves now in precisely this stage. They have developed reason and will sufficiently to keep the realm of feelings under control. This was not a wrong turn, an erroneous direction, my friends. It was necessary. But now another way must be taken. Yet this is what seems most threatening, what seems to conflict with all past endeavors. They identify and experience themselves almost entirely as the so-called ego, that part which wills and reasons. Every challenge to change the direction appears to their unconscious being as an enormous threat. For to activate the realm of feelings seems an entirely dangerous undertaking that leaves bare the most primitive, selfish, destructive feelings, which seem to be completely bottomless and final. This explains, in the deepest possible way, the enormous threat all individuals experience when they come to a certain crossroads in their overall development. With some, the threat may be so great that they go on and on overdeveloping their faculties of reason and will so that a lopsidedness comes into being.

Mankind as a whole is arrested at exactly this point. This is why a very uneven development exists, where more and more emphasis is being put for the longest time on the faculties of reason and will. It explains mankind's uneven development. Technologically, scientifically, he is disproportionately developed in comparison with his feeling qualities and his capacity to experience spiritually. Whenever emotions appear, they seem by far more negative than positive. Even man's attempt to preach love and spirituality has little to do (in most instances) with true emotional experience. More often than not, these are ideals and theories, a philosophy he adheres to in principle and conceptually, rather than feeling it. For the feeling self still appears as the great enemy and is accused of being totally unreliable and even dangerous.

The poverty of real feelings in the average human being is striking for those who begin to become more alive and real, who are no longer frozen. The scant feelings the average human being experiences are always controlled, always taken with a grain of salt, always very cautiously

approached -- whether or not you are aware of this fact does not alter it. It is part of your further path to become aware of it. For even the admission to yourself, "I feel half dead, I could feel more than I do, therefore the potential to do so must exist in me," brings you so much nearer to the state of self-realization than the blindness of confusing your desire to feel and love because you believe in it as a principle, with the actual fact of feeling and loving.

This is the general trend or stage in which man finds himself. He just has mastered, as it were, that stage in which primitively he gave in to every impulse of the realm of feelings, which is, at that surface level, mostly negative and destructive. He has just learned, with a lot of labor and effort, through many appearances, experiences, and forms of existence, to channel and to control this destructive, primitive, unguarded self that can go berserk and wreak so much havoc if it is left to its own devices. Every criminal or insane person bears witness to this fact. And everyone who is struggling in his own development feels threatened at any display of the unchanneled primitive self. This seems a great predicament, for how can self-realization be attained when the realm of feelings is denied, not transcended, when the entity does not learn to cope with the realm of feelings and discover for himself that there is something else "underneath" and that the realm of feelings is not a bottomless well of unknown terror, of reasonless violence and selfishness, of meaningless bleakness. All this exists, but is really a thin veneer. Once the reasoning faculties have been sufficiently developed in the course of evolution throughout the centuries of training of an individual entity, and once the entity has learned to execute his power of self-discipline, there is no longer any danger in encountering the world of feelings. The fear that he will be helplessly swept away by the feelings, once they are conscious, is unfounded. The faculties of reason and will are intact for all those who find themselves on this path, for if these faculties were not sufficiently developed, they could not ever go through even the rudimentary steps of such pathwork. They would be incapable of disciplining their lives. And where you do not do this, mind you my friends, you do so quite deliberately with an ulterior motive in mind. So, your fear of not possessing sufficient reason and will to control any action of the feeling world is unfounded.

Thus man has to learn to go into the direction opposite to the one he has hitherto taken. Instead of mastering, constraining, holding back the feelings, he has to learn to allow them to consciousness, to accept their existence, to let them be and observe them, to meet them without fright. Thus he will see how easy it is to let the feelings be without having to act upon them, but instead deliberately choosing the ensuing action.

Perhaps it is still not quite clear why it is necessary in the first place to hold back and constrain what eventually has to be let go of without hindrance. The answer is really simple and important to comprehend. When you observe a primitive person or an animal, you see that the consciousness does not allow yet for either reasoning or will. Therefore these faculties cannot be put to use so that when impulses come to the surface, they dominate. Will and reason are underdeveloped and therefore cannot stem the flood of the impulses of destructive emotions. Therefore many lifetimes have to be spent in order to train reason and will. Only when these faculties have been developed, can it be completely safe to allow primitive, destructive feelings to the surface without being compelled into action. A path such as this requires so much self-discipline and reasoning faculty in order to overcome the ingrained fear and consequent resistance that this is in itself a built-in safety measure. Even if reason and will have still their weak spots, they inadvertently and organically strengthen themselves exactly where it is needed by the courage and honesty, the self-discipline and will power necessary to come to this juncture. This is why there is nothing to fear.

Man's overall unconscious imprints are still so powerful that he is frightened of the feelings. So he uses his reason and will to deny their existence, to discipline them away from his consciousness. He does not comprehend that he no longer needs these controls, provided he is on a meaningful path of honest self-confrontation. He can now -- after millennia of training of will and reason which are now being used for honest and humble self-confrontation -- safely afford to allow himself to feel what he feels without falling into the danger of having to act upon the feeling, whether or not such an act is good in itself. He can now recognize the feeling. He can now execute his relaxed will power. This is where you are, my friends, or where you could be.

Those human beings whose overall development makes them ripe and ready for the realization of their divine kernel must now unlearn or relearn in a new way. A new balance structure has to be established. The very primitive man is lopsided in the sense he is completely controlled by his emotions, while will and reason are still too frail to enter into the process of living. Today's man, generally speaking (I do not think of the exceptions on both ends of the scale), is at the point where reason and will are overgrown and the emotional life thwarted. This makes union with the divine kernel as difficult (although not as far removed) as in the first stage. For the divine kernel is a living, breathing, pulsating, energizing mass of the highest consciousness and wisdom, self-perpetuating and self-creating in an ongoing process. It is so potently alive that there is no word to describe the intense nature of its aliveness. When the feelings are feared and therefore denied, aliveness is by necessity also denied, whether or not the entity is aware of this connection. Reason and will by themselves can never bring aliveness into the personality. They cannot bring the consciousness of the divine nucleus into the personality either. This is why the people who are most dominated by reason and will and have their feelings most controlled are those whose aliveness is very precarious.

You, my friends, who really want to come into your spiritual inheritance of your divine nature, you must not confuse spirituality with mere spiritual ideas. You must bring your living, feeling self into play even if this cannot happen in any other way than meeting destructiveness and pain. When you fully experience the hate and the pain in you without flinching, you will be surprised what happens. Much sooner than you think, hate, violence, and pain will dissolve and give way to a new aliveness. A sea of feeling will crystallize pleasure supreme, the capacity to experience such heights of joy as you never dreamed possible. With it, if you make room for it, a new sense of cosmic reality arises out of you. You are indeed strong enough, all of you, to go this way. The danger of being forced into actions against your reason and will is truly an illusion in the state you are in now. The danger is now your difficulty to admit that you are not yet who you want to be. But what an expensive price you pay for living life "as if." Once you decide to meet yourself as you are and go through the pain of some feelings, you will convince yourself very quickly that not only is the realm of feelings not bottomless, but that its veneer is really relatively quite superficial. Once you learn to cope with these feelings by just letting them be, they will dissolve so quickly that you will come to feel this new aliveness and delight very soon.

This must be the road. You will need help and guidance step by step, and this is what we shall concentrate on this coming year. A lot of guidance has already been activated and has come to your aid in approaches from all kinds of new sources and ways. In this lecture, I would like to discuss now another such aiding step which you can make use of and which constitutes an important aspect on our road. When you have reached in your pathwork a certain phase of awareness of emotions, you will come to see what you are constantly doing with some of your feelings -- a lot of your

feelings. What you are doing is using the busy, busy mind, the overemphasized reasoning faculty, to fit your feelings into pictures, to build theories why you feel a certain way. The mind is so overtrained in its business, overusing reason, that you think you need a reason to feel in a certain way. Thus it often escapes you what the real motives are, how the actual situation is. Immediately you weave a web of "reasons," of "explanations" to fixed images, to build and fit your concepts around and into the real feelings until their very life is squeezed out. Since the feelings are feared and reason is the saving measure, you concoct reasons for feeling. You are always full of explanations why you feel a certain way until no feeling remains -- only theory and explanation. This is so important, my friends. When you can see this, you will be able to use this aid I give you here.

Let us take as an example that you feel hurt. In many instances, this hurt is completely denied, even to the self. It is manipulated around into an accusation -- often elaborately and sometimes even using partially true factors about the perpetrator of the hurt. But at best, this can only be a tiny particle of the whole of the picture, either about the personality or the motives for the hurting act. Thus there is no longer any reality in the elaborate and reasonably sounding explanations and evaluations. The denied hurt turns into anger. This, too, is denied. The anger is also explained away by theorizing what brought the hurtful action about. All of this makes it impossible to really experience the hurt. And when an actual experience is denied, you cannot bring this experience truly behind you. You cannot really be done with it. And so it happens, and often you build on top of this structure a false, exaggerated hurt -- the game we so often mention, "see what you have done to me. My hurt now forces you to act differently." This kind of artificially exaggerated hurt is the result of all the false layers that separate the consciousness from the original real hurt. The false one is an unbearable pain that leads to desperation and never to a conclusion or satisfactory solution. The real hurt is a gentle, soft experience, never unbearable, always leaving the essence of the personality intact.

If you can let yourself feel such a hurt, simply and without adornment, stating the fact and why it hurts you, a new pattern is being created. If you can simply let the feeling be in you, you will learn not only to deal with your feelings undangerously, but also with your surroundings. This is the safest, most realistic way which will, at the same time, establish a new life line to the creative nucleus, your true identity. If you can endure this hurt and let it be -- even if you do not know or understand what hurts you -- admitting your confusion and its additional elements of hurt, you will not have to become violent, angry, destructive, vindictive, mean. All these are only reaction to a feeling you do not want to endure. This is the harm of denial which builds further layers of removal and alienation from your true self. You must learn to become calm with your mind and stop denying the feelings through the mind's agitatedness of fitting the hurtful event into fixed images and theories. Let it be! Feel what you feel, without having to do anything, either in action or in reasoning it out. Then you will experience a wonderful process. The negative, painful feeling will by itself dissolve, very naturally, not in illusion because you look away from it and cover it up underneath thick layers of misapplied reason and will, but naturally, as every living process must dissolve back into its original state if the natural process is not being interfered with. The original state is not pain but pleasure, not suffering but joy, not deadness but life, not hopelessness but forever expanding rich abundance of life. All these desirable facts of life cannot be forced into a self. If they are to be real and enduring, they must come naturally, organically, and spontaneously as a result of not flinching away from what is now, from what one really feels. This takes place as a very gradual process, gradual in proportion and to the degree the actual sensations and feelings are experienced without either denying or exaggerating them -- both of which amounts to the same thing. Thus you awaken your

spiritual center, which will fill your entire being. You will be filled with a sense of being safe, with strong, beautiful new feelings and also eventually with new knowledge, new insight, new perceptions and intuitions -- and even quite new faculties. They will spring from deep within, filling you with the sense that they are truly you, not pretenses or faculties whose manifestations depend on others or on circumstances outside your control. You will gain understanding based on completely different dynamics than the understanding you produce in this artificial process of fitting any feeling you allow yourself into a superstructure of explanation and reasoning. Seeing these superstructures as spiritual forms, we see how most human beings go around with huge lopsided forms growing out of their subtle bodies, which cause such heaviness. They must be dissolved in the process of evolving.

You may note that for the longest time our path was concerned with meeting your actions, thoughts, and concepts, your beliefs and attitudes, in honesty. Now you must learn to honestly register and endure your feelings. The gentle hurt first appears more difficult to bear than the artificially aggrandized one because the latter seems to promise dramatic action from without. It is a direct expression of saying no to the real, much more gentle hurt. No dangerous destructiveness will arise when the soft and gentle hurt is accepted. Out of it, soft and gentle good feelings will arise, swelling stronger and forever more securely rooted, carrying the self into a most fruitful and creative life. More and more, vibrant energy and deep truth, perception and wisdom must come forth from the center of your being.

This process I describe here requires, of course, many specific approaches and guidance along the way. We will be considerably concerned with this in many ways. There will be many opportunities in which you can learn this. You can all begin right now in a simple and direct way by emphasizing in your meditations, "I would like to know, experience, and feel what I really feel" -- about whatever the issue may be, whatever the mood of the day or the moment. Beware of either talking yourself out of it by suspecting an irrationality, or talking yourself into it by building a case. Both imply a too active mind. Let the mind be passive and gently, gently let the feeling come up -- whatever it may be. The calmer you are and the more relaxed and intently you "listen" to the nature of your feeling, the more it will be the original feeling, not the cover, not the result of denying the original one. Once you permit yourself the original impact of feeling, you are so much nearer the life center out of which all good flows. Meditate that you request guidance. Meditate that you have the strength to endure a little pain -- a pain that is in you anyway, only so much worse as a result of what you are doing to and with it. Tell yourself that the pain is the gateway to pleasure and fulfillment, to joy and happiness. Only by encountering the original pain can you eliminate the artificial deadness of the realm of feelings, which slowly spreads and makes the faculties of will and reason act like a robot, so different in nature from the vital flow of life that is the by-product of the realm of feelings.

In our next lecture, I will discuss another facet that will help you to no longer fear the realm of feelings. I will talk about how to genuinely eliminate the destructiveness you fear so much that you shut out life itself. What I have given you here is a vital key for all of you.

Do not fight the pain, for in fighting it you avoid the experience whose full acceptance is necessary in order to really grow out of it and become subsequently stronger and happier. You will thus learn to recognize the subtle and yet enormous difference between genuine and dishonest, manufactured emotions.

May you all remind yourself, again and again and again and again, that there is no problem that cannot be resolved, there is no point on which the path needs to stop, for anyone. Expansion of creative living, of forever growing capacity to experience the goodness of life is truly infinite. Thus the path ceases to be a threatening or laborious chore when you meet your obstructions and illusions, but becomes liberation itself. Even self-realization is not one specific, finite goal. The person with the gravest afflictions and distortions, who says, "I will go all the way, there is no stopping me because the creative force in me will go to work to the extent I let it," is by far nearer total fulfillment and realization of his true self than the one whose intellectual powers, his reason and will faculties function sufficiently to hide the inner alienation and who therefore thinks his way need not go through the pain.

Let the divine consciousness infiltrate your entire being, my friends. The way I show and guide you will make this more than a hope, an ideal, and a faraway goal. The reality of this will show you how different life becomes. This can be yours, every one of you, if you really want it. Your mind has the choice. This year, again, great and wonderful forces are brought here and stream forth. They are partly the result of your sincere good efforts, the overcoming that already occurred, and the love feelings here as they exist. Partly they are an influx of spiritual realms concerned with furthering important ventures on this earth. I bless all of you -- all my new friends as well, who have joined this path and who have the excitement and adventure ahead of them, the path of discovery of a new and beautiful world, even if occasionally the illusion of pain must shortly be endured. Blessings for my familiar friends also, with whom I am proud and happy to work. Blessings for you all for this entire year to come. Be God!

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